Individual Support Plan Process (ISP)

At Little Miracles, we value each child's individual personality, strengths, and interests, and we are committed to providing a safe, educational, inclusive, and supportive environment for all children, families, and educators. This commitment is guided by our 'Access and Inclusion Policy', which outlines our approach to ensuring equitable participation and meaningful inclusion for every child within our service.

The Individual Support Plan (ISP) is designed to support children living with a disability, or children who are currently undergoing assessment or diagnosis, to access and fully participate in our early childhood setting. The ISP focuses on each child's unique strengths, interests, and needs, and outlines inclusive strategies, reasonable adjustments, and achievable goals to support their learning, wellbeing, and sense of belonging.

This plan is created in partnership with families and educators and, where appropriate, is informed by recommendations from relevant allied health or medical professionals. We value working closely with families and recognise that you know your child best. The ISP promotes open communication, shared decision-making, and collaboration to ensure your child receives high-quality care and education alongside their peers in a safe and inclusive environment.

To understand this process there are a couple of important things to keep in mind.

- Every child and family are unique and therefore each situation will be approached in its own context.
- The ISP remains in place for the duration of the child's enrolment and evolves as the child grows and their needs change.
- The continuation of the ISP will depend on the ongoing healthy partnership between the family, educators in the room and centre leadership team. This includes all stakeholders' adherence to the 'Social Covenant' that parents and staff to sign committing to working together in a constructive partnership.
- A child living with a disability may at times display behaviours that are challenging and could impact their own safety, the wellbeing of peers, educators, or the learning environment. When these behaviours significantly affect safety or participation, Little Miracles will implement the Behaviour Support Process (BSP) alongside the Individual Support Plan (ISP).
- A risk assessment will be developed alongside the ISP to identify potential risks and implement strategies to minimise those risks. This ensures the health, safety, and wellbeing of the child, their peers, educators, and all individuals within the group care environment.

Examples of children who may require and 'Individual Support Plan' (ISP) **is usually characterised by (but not limited to);**

Medical Conditions:

- Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)
- Cerebral Palsy
- Child undergoing assessment for disability.
- Hearing Impairments
- Attention deficit Disorder (ADD or ADHD)
- Syndrome or chromosome disorders
- Physical Disability eg mobility impairments.
- Global delay

Environment Audit

When a child is identified as requiring an Individual Support Plan (ISP), the Nominated Supervisor will support the Room Leader and educators to conduct a reflective review of the learning environment.

The following key elements will be considered:

Physical Environment

- How is the environment arranged to support the child's access, participation, and independence?
- Is the environment adequately resourced to support the child's engagement?
- Are additional resources, equipment, or modifications required to improve access?
- Does the daily routine promote and support the child's participation and inclusion?

A great way to assess the learning environment is to use a 'Growing Champions Environment Audit'.

Guidance and Behaviour Support

- Is the *Growing Champions* guidebook being actively used as a resource to support the child, the group, and the overall learning environment?
- Are educators consistently implementing positive guidance strategies that uphold the rights, dignity, and wellbeing of all children?
- Are expectations for behaviour developmentally appropriate and clearly supported?

Educator Support

- Do educators require additional training, mentoring, or professional development to effectively support the child's access and inclusion?

Administration of Medication

Where a child enrolled under an Individual Support Plan (ISP) requires medication to support their health, wellbeing, or participation, Little Miracles will administer medication strictly in accordance with our Administration of Medication Procedure, Administration of Authorised medication Policy and all relevant regulatory requirements. A copy of the Administration of Medication Policy will be provided to the family during enrolment or at the commencement of the ISP process to ensure they are fully informed about our procedures, responsibilities, and compliance obligations regarding the safe administration of medication.

Collaborative Partnerships with Families and Community

The success of an Individual Support Plan (ISP) depends on collaboration between the child, their family, educators, and other professionals involved in their care. The plan should be implemented consistently across all settings, including home, school, and community environments, to ensure that the strategies are effective, and the child experiences consistent support.
Little Miracles values, respects and fosters collaborative partnerships with families, allied health and other professionals to support children's learning, development and wellbeing. Educators are to communicate and share information with families respectfully and with empathy and sensitivity.

How the ISP and Behaviour Support Plan (BSP) Work Together

The Individual Support Plan (ISP) is a holistic, long-term plan that focuses on a child's overall participation, inclusion, development, and wellbeing. It outlines strengths, goals, environmental adjustments, and inclusive teaching strategies that support the child across all aspects of their learning.
If behaviours arise that require more targeted and structured intervention, a Behaviour Support Plan (BSP) may be developed alongside the ISP. The BSP is more specific and focuses on:

- Identifying triggers and contributing factors
- Proactive strategies to prevent behaviours
- Clear response strategies for educators
- Safety planning where required
- Consistent approaches across the team

The BSP does not replace the ISP. Instead, it works in partnership with the ISP to ensure the child receives both inclusive developmental support and structured behavioural guidance when necessary.

Both plans are developed collaboratively with families and, where appropriate, informed by external professionals. They are reviewed regularly to ensure strategies remain effective, respectful, and aligned with the child's evolving needs.

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Individual Support Plan

Action Steps

1. Identification of Need

An Individual Support Plan (ISP) may be initiated when:

- During the enrolment process, a child is identified as having a diagnosed disability.
- A child is currently undergoing assessment or receives a diagnosis while enrolled at the service.

2. Collaborative Family Meeting

At Little Miracles, we know that families are the experts on their child. Before commencing the Individual Support Plan (ISP) process, the Nominated Supervisor will organise a Collaborative Family Meeting with the child's family and the Room Leader.

The meeting may also include:

- The Nominated Supervisor and/or Centre Leadership Team
- External professionals (where appropriate and with family consent)

During this meeting, we work together to:

- Celebrate and identify the child's strengths, interests, and abilities
- Discuss areas where additional support may be helpful
- Review any professional reports or recommendations
- Collaboratively create shared goals, strategies, and actions to support the child's participation, learning, and wellbeing
- External options for further support that families can access such as NDIS, referral to specialists and Inclusion Support Funding (ISS).
- The Area Manager will support the Nominated Supervisor or educators with any coaching or guidance in the facilitation of the meeting

3. Development of the ISP

The ISP captures a complete picture of the child and outlines strategies that support their participation, learning, and wellbeing. Key areas of the ISP include:

Child's needs:

- Diagnosis / Assessment: Any formal diagnosis or current assessments

- Identified Barriers: Learning, physical, social, or other challenges
- Current reports/Inclusion Plan from medical professionals:
- Early Intervention: Allied health support, programs, NDIS involvement

Child Profile

- Interests: e.g., animals, climbing, creative play
- Strengths: e.g., drawing, literacy, problem-solving
- Behavioural Traits & Triggers: Traits, stims, or situations that may lead to dysregulation

Goals

- Individual goals set collaboratively with the family and Nominated supervisor with input from educators that are reasonable and support positive, inclusive outcomes.

Strategies

- Strategies developed collaboratively with families, educators, and, where appropriate, external professionals.

Risk assessment

- A risk assessment will be developed alongside the ISP to identify potential risks and implement strategies to minimise those risks. This ensures the health, safety, and wellbeing of the child, their peers, educators, and all individuals within the group care environment.

4. Implementation

Once the ISP is developed, A copy of the child's 'Individualised Support Plan' (ISP) will be:

- Emailed the family.
- Emailed to the Area Manager
- Given to room educators to be placed in the room's 'Emergency Contact Folder' Tab 4

Educators will implement the agreed strategies consistently within the learning environment. This may include:

- Environmental modifications
- Visual supports
- Intentional teaching strategies
- Routine adjustments that are reasonable.
- Social or emotional support strategies

5. Monitoring and Review

The ISP is reviewed regularly, or sooner if circumstances change, to ensure it continues to support the child's learning, wellbeing, and participation.

Room leaders and educators are to communicate during Room Leader meetings or other relevant times, the progress of ISP within their room including highlights, achievements, concerns or challenges.

Collaborative Family Meetings are held within the timeframe outlined in the ISP to review the child's current progress, keeping families at the heart of planning, reflection, and decision-making.

The service or family may request a review of the child's ISP at any time during its duration. Educators will document progress notes between review periods on the ISP to track the child's development, support ongoing planning, and inform discussions during review meetings.

The Nominated Supervisor oversees and manages review meetings and will email families the meeting invite

During review meetings, the following will be addressed:

- Celebrate the child's progress and milestones
- Reflect on the effectiveness of strategies and make reasonable adjustments as needed
- Review and, if necessary, update goals to ensure they remain meaningful and achievable
- Consider any new recommendations from families or professionals
- External options for further support that families can access such as NDIS, referral to specialists and Inclusion Support Funding (ISS).

End of ISP / Exiting Care

At Little Miracles, we are committed to providing inclusive, safe, and supportive care for every child. In rare circumstances, if a child's needs cannot be safely met within the service, and reasonable adjustments have been explored but are not sufficient to ensure the safety, wellbeing, or meaningful inclusion of the child or others, the following steps will be considered:

- Review all strategies, supports, and adjustments to identify further options
- Engage collaboratively with the family, educators, and, where appropriate, external professionals to explore alternatives
- Consider referral to a more specialised service or support network better suited to meet the child's individual needs
- Provide families with clear information, guidance, and support throughout the process

- This approach ensures that any decision regarding the continuation of care is thoughtful, transparent, and prioritises the safety, wellbeing, and inclusion of all children and educators within the Little Miracles community.

Transition to School & Accessing Early Intervention

At Little Miracles, we know that preparing children for primary school starts long before their first day. Educators need to be especially aware of, and plan for, the supports required to help children living with a disability transition successfully to school. Early identification of developmental needs and timely access to support helps children build confidence, develop skills, and feel ready for school.

Example Pathway for Developmental Support

- **LA Room:** Child begins in the LA Room
- **RR Room:** Educators notice developmental concerns; parents may initiate a referral for assessment
- **SS Room:** Developmental assessment conducted; a diagnosis may be received during the transition to AA Room
- **AA Room:** Application for early intervention classes is submitted (around August/September)
- **MM Room:** Child begins attending early intervention classes
- **Primary School:** Child transitions to primary school with supports established

Key Message: Start Early

For children with an Individual Support Plan (ISP), early planning and action by educators are especially important. Accessing the right supports and services takes time, and children may miss out on opportunities if needs are identified and communicated too late—sometimes only at school orientation. For children with higher support needs, including those on an ISP, specialised early intervention classes are limited on the Central Coast, and families may need to explore options across the region to ensure their child can access the most appropriate support.

Transition to Primary School: Little Miracles Approach

For children accessing early intervention, school transition is a collaborative process over 1–2 years, involving families, educators and school staff. The process ensures continuity of learning, support, and a smooth move into school life.

1. Early Planning (1–2 years before school)

- Work closely with families to begin discussions on the transition to school process 1–2 years before their child starts. Guide families on how to approach the school and communicate their child's needs, particularly if physical adjustments are required (e.g., ramps, accessible toilets). Families are encouraged to contact the school their child will enrol in for kindergarten and speak with the school counsellor for advice and support. These discussions can take place during an ISP review meeting, ensuring the child's needs and goals are considered collaboratively and in a timely way.

2. Collaboration- Families, early intervention teachers, and school staff work together to create a tailored plan

- With permission form the family share information about the child's strengths, interests, and support needs.
- Invite local schoolteachers to attend the service to observe the child within the learning environment.

3. Familiarisation

- Encourage the family to share images of the school environment, teachers or share Family News from orientation visits to help the child prepare for the upcoming transition to school.

4. Documentation

- Use the NSW Transition to School Statement to share key information between Little Miracles and the school

6. Supporting the Child at Home

- Encourage the family to practice school routines like managing lunchboxes and dressing independently.
- Maintain consistent sleep schedules
- Read stories about starting school and visit school playgrounds to reduce anxiety
- Include the child in conversations about what they are excited or worried about

Available Support- https://education.nsw.gov.au/teaching-and learning/curriculum/early-learning/early-intervention

- Families should speak with the principal of their local public school about Department of Education Early Intervention Services
- For further guidance, visit the Early Intervention page for parents and carers

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Realistic Timeline for Accessing Early Intervention Class and Kindergarten Support Class
(Public Health Pathway)

